



MOBAs and MMOs (at the time anyway) saw, obviously made publishers instantly veer in that direction. And the PC market's newfound success in the multiplayer market only meant that consoles would soon follow in the same direction. Today eSports is huge with huge prize pools and millions of viewers worldwide,



being able to compete easily – and even surpass in some cases – other sports in terms of scale. There was big money to be made, teams to sponsor, talent to find, and a huge mass of followers ready to consume it all. Competitive eSports has much more variety now, from sports based games like FIFA, NBA, and Madden NFL, to shooters like Counter Strike: Global Offensive and the more recent Overwatch, and of course the ever popular MOBAs, League of Legends and Dota. Arcade fighters like Dead or Alive, Mortal Kombat, and Street Fighter are also popular games which are enjoyed more competitively than as just single player games.

Multiplayer only games

Yep, that's right, many games these days release as multiplayer only. They have no single player content or story to them whatsoever. Having no single player aspect to focus on does help the developers though. Microsoft has been pushing for 24/7 connection to the internet on the Xbox for a long time, and despite gamers not really liking the fact that your Xbox had to be connected at all times – they were pretty vocal about it – game developers seemed ok with it. Respawn was the first to take this leap, with their highly anticipated multiplayer only game, Titanfall. Now there were many problems with the Titanfall release, for one thing, a AAA



game of this calibre was normally expected to deliver various single player, co-op and multiplayer game modes. But Titanfall focused on just one of those, while costing the same as games that did offer all of the above. However, despite the multiplayer only model and the price tag, the game was actually quite successful, with well over 10 million players since its launch. This kind of success meant that other publishers would soon follow suit and as expected 2K came up with Evolve, a 4v1 online title which despite much scrutiny still managed to sell over 2.5 million copies, then of course EA went and adopted this model for their popular FPS series, Battlefield. This when they already had Battlefield which didn't have single player anyway. This large scale adoption of the multiplayer model was taking its toll on the single player aspect. The Call of Duty and Battlefield of the time were both considered duds in the single player department, with lack lustre campaigns which simply didn't offer enough. The new Battlefield, which came sailing on the Star Wars hype, also sunk after players realised it didn't offer enough. However some actually did very well, take Destiny's The Taken King expansion, which basically fixed Destiny and made it worth playing, and Halo 5: Guardians. But keep in mind, Halo is well known for its amazing single player narrative, making it a prime example of a game being done right.

If you don't want to be called a n00b

Then avoid multiplayer. It's sad but it's true, the world is a horrible place and the internet even more so. The amount of toxicity in online games is ridiculously high, especially in competitive titles. Games like Dota, League and CS:GO are infamous for having toxic player bases. Of course, one doesn't HAVE to play these titles for an enjoyable online experience and there are definitely other games out there with much nicer